

HEURISTIC EVALUATION

Antz Onboarding Guide web experience

The live guide, measured against Nielsen's ten usability heuristics, with what to fix first. A follow-up to the 25 September evaluation.

Date

29 September 2026

Build

Live, commit bab58d1

Audience

Staff who use Antz

Findings

16 (3 major)

A clear, well-built guide, let down by missing screens

Verdict

Finding and reading a feature now works well. Area and module tabs, search from any page, a feature window on desktop and a full-screen sheet on phones make every task a few taps away. The biggest problems are about content, not behaviour. Four modules show stock photos as their screens, some icons are broken or repeated, and some copy still speaks to buyers. Two behaviour issues matter most: Back leaves the page instead of closing a screen, and key text is below WCAG contrast.

Findings by heuristic

HEURISTIC	3	2	1
1 · Visibility	0	1	1
2 · Real-world match	1	2	1
3 · Control, freedom	1	0	0
4 · Consistency	1	2	0
5 · Error prevention	0	1	0
6 · Recognition	0	0	1
7 · Efficiency	0	1	0
8 · Minimalism	0	0	1
9 · Error recovery	0	1	0
10 · Help, docs	0	1	0

Columns count findings at each severity. No catastrophic (4) issues were found.

Recommended first moves

- Stop showing stock photos as screens.** Show “Screens coming soon” until the 31 captures exist. (H2.1)
- Make Back close the window or sheet.** (H3.1)
- Fix contrast** on selected chips, orange labels and grey hints. (H4.1)
- Redraw the broken “report” icon** used by the Operations area and 14 features. (H2.2)
- Send module search results to the module page.** (H5.1)

3
Major (3)

9
Minor (2)

4
Cosmetic (1)

What is working well

Always know where you are.

Area tabs with photos, module chips in the area colour and a pinned bar on scroll keep area and module in view.

Search from anywhere.

A menu icon, / or Ctrl/Cmd + K opens search on every page; results go straight to a feature’s screen.

Screens that read well.

The desktop window and the phone sheet show a large screen beside its title and description, with arrows, swipe and dots.

Shareable and reversible.

Every module and feature has its own link; Esc and click outside close; focus returns to the card.

One colour system.

Each area’s colour carries through tabs, chips, cards, icons and the window, so modules are recognisable.

Considerate motion.

Every effect switches off under reduced motion, and the menu stays readable over the photo and on light pages.

How the evaluation was done

An expert review of the live site at 1440px and 390px in Chrome, walking five everyday tasks for staff and checking each screen against Nielsen's ten heuristics. Behaviour, contrast and page weight were measured in the browser.

Tasks walked

1. Find how to record a vaccination and see its screen.
2. Switch from Housing to a module in Medical & Treatment.
3. From a module page, search for "deworm" and open it.
4. As a new user, work through Getting Started.
5. On a phone, open a feature, step to the next and go back.

Severity scale (Nielsen)

4 CATASTROPHIC Must fix before release

3 MAJOR Important to fix, high priority

2 MINOR Fix, lower priority

1 COSMETIC Fix if time allows

Limits

One evaluator; a single reviewer typically finds about a third of problems, so a short test with staff should follow. Screen readers were not tested live. The audience is staff who already use Antz, not prospects.

Progress since 25 September

EARLIER FINDING	NOW	STATUS
Phone module pages changed a screen out of view	Features open in a full-screen sheet on phones	Fixed
Placeholder icons on module cards	Every module card has its own icon; some feature icons are still broken (H2.2)	Partly fixed
Kit sections spoke to trainees, not prospects	The audience is now staff, so training language fits	Resolved
Stock photos framed as screens	Still there, and now shown for every feature of four modules (H2.1)	Open
Booking depended on an email link	Booking buttons removed; not needed for staff	Resolved
Rotating search cue never pauses	Unchanged, and added to the header search (H1.2)	Open
No way to move between areas and modules	Area and module tabs, pinned bar, previous/next	Fixed

FINDINGS

16 findings across the ten heuristics

H1 Visibility of system status

Does the guide show what is happening?

H1.1 A feature card looks selected before anything is chosen

1 COSMETIC

- SEEN** On every module page the first card loads white, outlined and with a filled icon, the "selected" look, although nothing is open.
- WHY** It suggests the first feature is already showing, or has been read. On desktop and phones the screen only appears once a card is opened.
- FIX** Load with no card selected; mark a card only while its window or sheet is open, or after it has been viewed.

H1.2 The rotating search cue never pauses

2 MINOR

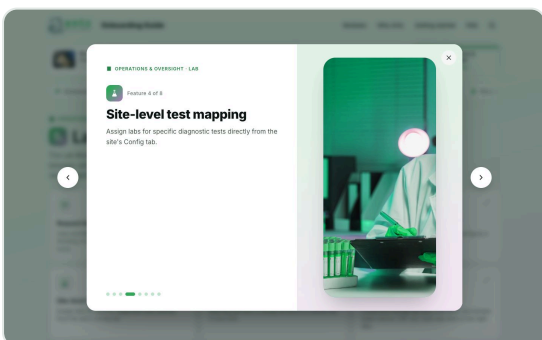
- SEEN** The banner search cycles "Search Notes Module... Note type & linking..." every 2.4 seconds for as long as the page is open. The header search does the same while open. Enter on a cue does nothing because the box is empty.
- WHY** Endless motion next to the main entry point distracts people reading the hero, and fails WCAG 2.2.2 (pause, stop, hide).
- FIX** Stop after three cycles and on hover or focus; let Tab or → accept the cue shown.

H2 Match between system and the real world

Does it show and say what staff will meet in Antz?

H2.1 Four web modules show a stock photo as every screen

3 MAJOR

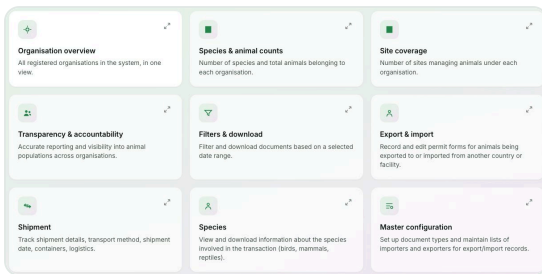


Lab, feature 4 of 8: the stock photo stands in for the app.

- SEEN** Lab, Diet, Pharmacy · Web and Compliance have no captures. Every one of their 31 features opens the same stock photo inside the device frame: a scientist, a pile of fruit, pills in a trolley, a vet with a tablet.
- WHY** The guide's job is to prepare staff for the real screens. A photo framed as the app teaches nothing and makes every other screen less trustworthy.
- FIX** Until captures exist, drop the device and show "Screens coming soon" in the window. Capture the 31 screens listed in the screenshot audit.

H2.2 Some icons are broken or say the wrong thing

2 MINOR



SEEN

Compliance: two solid squares, and a person for Export & import.

WHY

FIX

The “report” icon draws as a solid green square: its bars are not cut out. It marks 14 features and the whole Operations & Oversight area (chips, tabs, cards). Mortality & Lifecycle’s area icon is a plain oval. 186 features share 30 icons, so neighbours repeat (“manage” 24×, “filter” 18×), and some mismatch: Export & import shows a person.

Icons are read before titles. A blank square reads as “missing”, and repeats make cards in a module hard to tell apart at a glance.

Redraw “report” with its bars cut out and give Mortality a clearer mark. Then give each feature an icon for its own action, starting with the most-used modules.

H2.3 Some copy still speaks to buyers, not staff

2 MINOR

SEEN

Banner: “Take a five-minute look at how Antz works”. Menu: “Why Antz”. FAQ heading “Questions teams ask first”, with questions such as “What is Antz?” and “We run more than one site. Does that work?”. The repo README calls the site the “prospect edition”.

WHY

Staff already use Antz. Sales framing makes the guide feel like marketing and hides the everyday questions (“How do I reassign a record?”, “Why can’t I see a module?”).

FIX

Reword for users: “Find any task in Antz, with the real screens”. Rename “Why Antz” to “About Antz”; rewrite the FAQ around access, roles, sync and where to get help.

H2.4 Labels follow the system, not the reader

1 COSMETIC

SEEN

Getting Started is labelled “Module 03 · Onboarding flow”, while card 03 is Collection. Names carry “Module” (“Notes Module”, “Helpdesk Module”); “Hospital Information Management System · App” overflows tabs and chips.

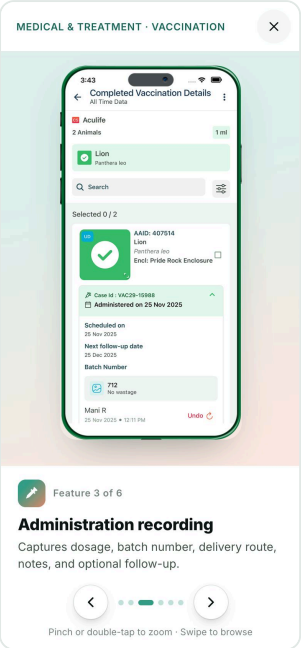
WHY

Two “Module 03”s make numbers unreliable as a way to find things, and long names are cut off on phones.

FIX

Drop the number from the kit label; drop “Module” from names; shorten HIMS to “Hospital · App / Web”.

H3.1Back leaves the page instead of closing the window or sheet3 MAJOR



SEEN

With a feature window (desktop) or the full-screen sheet (phones) open, the browser's Back, or Android's back gesture, skips the module page and returns to the previous page. Tested: Vaccination window open → Back → home page.

WHY

On phones the sheet fills the screen, so Back is the natural way to close it. People lose their place and must find the module again.

FIX

Add a history entry when the window or sheet opens and close it on Back, so Back steps out one level, as on the phone gallery in most apps.

Phone sheet: fills the screen, so Back is the instinctive exit.

H4.1Contrast falls below WCAG on key text3 MAJOR



SEEN

White text on the selected chip gradient measures 1.8:1 (teal end) to 2.4:1. Orange section labels measure 2.8:1. The grey hint and helper text measure 3.2:1 on the page tint and 3.8:1 on white. WCAG AA needs 4.5:1 for text this size.

WHY

Selected state, section labels and hints are exactly what orients people. Low contrast hides them on bright screens and for anyone with low vision.

FIX

Use dark ink on the light chip gradient (about 9:1); darken the orange to #B8431F and the grey to #5E6B67.

H4.2 The menu mixes places and jumps

2 MINOR

- | | |
|------|--|
| SEEN | "Modules" and "FAQ" scroll the home page; "Why Antz" and "Getting started" open pages. "Why Antz" lands on a page titled "What is Antz Systems?". The Objective page has no menu link. |
| WHY | The same kind of control does two different things, and a label that does not match its page makes people doubt where they are. |
| FIX | Make every menu item a place: Start here (the three kit pages), Modules, FAQ. Match labels to page titles. |

H4.3 Three chip styles and two list styles

2 MINOR

- | | |
|------|--|
| SEEN | Selected chips use a teal-to-green gradient on the home page and "start here" pages, but the area colour on module pages. Module pages list features as cards; the home Featured workflow still lists the same kind of features as rows. |
| WHY | Similar controls that look different make people relearn them, and a design system is easier to extend when each pattern has one form. |
| FIX | Pick one selected-chip rule (area colour everywhere, brand gradient where there is no area). Use the card layout for the Featured workflow. |

H5 Error prevention

Does the guide stop people going the wrong way?

H5.1 A module search result opens a feature, not the module

2 MINOR

- | | |
|------|---|
| SEEN | Searching "deworm" and choosing the module result "Deworming" opens the feature window at feature 1. The module page with all its features is behind a dimmed backdrop. |
| WHY | People choosing a module expect its overview. Landing inside feature 1 hides the other features and needs an extra close. |
| FIX | Link module results to <code>#/m/<id></code> and feature results to <code>#/m/<id>/<n></code> . |

H6 Recognition rather than recall

Is everything needed visible when needed?

H6.1 Long area names are cut off on phones

1 COSMETIC

- | | |
|------|--|
| SEEN | In the pinned bar and area tabs, names shorten to "Operations & ..." and "Medical & Tre...", and the area pill is the only area cue once the page is scrolled. |
| WHY | People have to remember which area they are in rather than read it. |
| FIX | Use short area names on phones ("Medical", "Operations", "Mortality") and keep the colour dot. |

H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use

Does it serve both first-time and returning users?

H7.1 Screenshots are heavier than they need to be

2 MINOR

SEEN	The screenshot folder is 39 MB; the largest single screen is 1.9 MB. The home page transfers 4.0 MB in 75 requests; a module page about 0.8 MB before any screen is opened, plus up to 1.9 MB per screen.
WHY	Staff check the guide on phones, on site Wi-Fi or mobile data. Slow screens break the one-tap flow the design depends on.
FIX	Serve screens as WebP at display size (about 80–150 KB each) with a small preview first; expect around 90% less data.

H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design

Is every element earning its place?

H8.1 Motion has grown into ten separate effects

1 COSMETIC

SEEN	Banner rise, chip fill sweep, drawn borders, card deal-in, tab glide, content swap, radial window, arrow loop, pager rise and kit rise. All respect reduced motion.
WHY	For a reference people return to daily, repeated entrances slow reading. Each effect is pleasant; together they compete.
FIX	Keep motion on first entry and direct feedback (hover, open, switch); drop entrance replays on return visits and in the pinned bar.

H9 Help users recognise, diagnose and recover from errors

What happens when something is missing?

H9.1 Broken or old links go home silently

2 MINOR

SEEN	A link to an unknown module (for example <code>#/m/nope</code>) sends people to the home page with no message.
WHY	Links shared in chat or bookmarked before a rename will break without explanation, and the person cannot tell whether the module exists.
FIX	Show a short "We couldn't find that page" message with search and the module list, and keep redirects for renamed modules.

H10.1	The only route to help is an email address	2 MINOR
SEEN	The guide’s help section and FAQ point to hello@antz.systems. There is no path by role (keeper, vet, admin), no “what’s new”, and Getting Started has one screen for six features.	
WHY	New staff learn by role and task. Without a starting path for their role, they browse 32 modules to find the few they use.	
FIX	Add “Start by role” paths on the home page, a “What’s new” list for releases, and complete the Getting Started screens.	

What to fix, in order

Now

This week, mostly small code changes

- Hide stock photos; show "Screens coming soon" H2.1
- Back closes the window or sheet H3.1
- Contrast fixes H4.1
- Redraw "report", new Mortality mark H2.2
- Module search results open the module H5.1

Next

Copy, navigation and polish

- Staff-facing copy and FAQ H2.3
- Menu as places: Start here, Modules, FAQ H4.2
- One chip rule; cards on home H4.3
- "Page not found" with search H9.1
- Cue pauses; no preselected card H1.1–2

Later

Content and performance

- Capture the 44 missing screens H2.1
- WebP screens, previews first H7.1
- Start-by-role paths, What's new H10.1
- Icons per feature; short names H2.2, H2.4, H6.1
- Trim repeat animations H8.1

Validate. After the "Now" fixes, ask five staff from different roles to complete the five tasks above on their own phones. Watch for where they hesitate; most remaining issues will show up in the first two tasks.